

OUR CALL

DAL WIN PROB

DAL by 0.3

51%



IND win 49% · pick'em (0) · DAL win 51%

Projected score DAL 84 — IND 85 · Total 182 (market 186)

Some inputs served from the most-recent available build (winprob) — see companion file for detail.

Read

DAL is the narrow side of a near coin-flip (51% to win). The catch: DAL is down a rotation piece — A. Fudd (impact +1.2) is OUT and already removed from the projection below.

- DAL is the narrow side of a near coin-flip here (51% to win); we project DAL 84, IND 85.
- The model's on-court player ratings tilt to IND — its top three rate +5.9 combined vs +2.7 on the other side (impact = points added vs an average player; see the box).
- Availability: DAL without A. James, A. Fudd, C. Verona (3 OUT); IND without D. Dantas (1 OUT) — OUT players are excluded from the box; the minutes of any projected among them are redistributed into the rotation below.
- How sure: 4 games in 5 the DAL margin lands between -16 and +16 (+ = DAL ahead) — single games swing a lot, and even so DAL loses outright about 49% of the time.

Injuries & availability — out of the projected box

TEAM	PLAYER	STATUS / CAUSE	GAMES MISSED	EXP. RETURN
IND	Damiris Dantas	Knee — out for season	11	Out for season
DAL	Azzi Fudd	Knee	5	TBD
DAL	Aziaha James	Leg	2	Aug 23
DAL	Costanza Verona	Out	25	Sep 17

A deeper look

What tonight means

A win tonight puts DAL's playoff chances at 100% — a loss drops them to 100%.

Across both teams that makes this the 2nd-biggest playoff-swing game of this week's 14 remaining games.

IND

if they win

100%

if they lose

100%

Playoff swing: 0 points · Typical seed: about 4th with a win, 5th with a loss.

DAL

if they win

100%

if they lose

100%

Playoff swing: 0 points · Typical seed: about 7th either way.

Source: the rest of the season replayed 10,000 times, split by tonight's result (may differ from the headline odds by a fraction of a point — same simulation, different run counts).

Season odds — playoffs & title

IND	PLAYOFFS 100%	TITLE 7.1%	
DAL	PLAYOFFS 100%	TITLE 3.1%	

Source: live 1M-run season simulation (the board's odds core).

Every projected line

IND

Projected lineup — seeded from the five who actually started this team's last game, on 2026-08-18; projected minutes fill any slot that lineup no longer covers.

[illegible]

	#	PLAYER	IMPACT	MIN	PTS	REB	AST	3PM
	3	R. Johnson G · 5'8" · thin sample	+0.0	2.6	1.0 0–12	0.3 0–4	0.2 0–3	0.1
28% of min, 31 GP · #99/212 league · 90%: pts 0-15 reb 0-6 ast 0-4 · 11.3 mpg, cap 25 · This is the player we know least about: too little record to project from and no earlier record of her own to fall back on, so her line rests on the positional average. The range is wide on purpose · 3.4/1.9/1.3 per game								
		Team		200.0	84.6	32.5	20.3	8.6
ptcile = Offense / Defense / Playmaking / Rebounding / X-factor (2025 league percentile) · 90% = the range nine games in ten · players are projected from their last ten games unless the row says otherwise								

DAL								
Projected lineup — seeded from the five who actually started this team's last game, on 2026-08-17; projected minutes fill any slot that lineup no longer covers.								
	5	P. Bueckers	+1.2	32.7	19.2 14–30	3.6 1–8	4.7 3–7	1.5
84% of min, 33 GP · #18/212 league · 90%: pts 11-33 reb 1-9 ast 2-9 · 33.4 mpg, cap 38 · ptcile 95/62/97/25/78 · 20.5/4.1/5.8 per game								
	24	A. Ogunbowale	-1.0	31.8	16.8 11–27	3.5 2–8	3.8 2–7	1.6
74% of min, 34 GP · #209/212 league · 90%: pts 9-31 reb 2-9 ast 1-8 · 29.6 mpg, cap 38 · ptcile 72/74/89/3/33 · 19-25: -1.5/+0.7/+2.7/-0.2/+0.8/+1.8/+0.4, best 21 · 14.4/3.1/3.0 per game								
	8	A. Smith	+1.0	28.7	11.8 6–22	7.0 4–11	1.6 0–4	1.3
44% of min, 27 GP · #45/212 league · 90%: pts 5-26 reb 4-12 ast 0-6 · 17.4 mpg, cap 38 · ptcile 60/72/70/71/74 · 19-25: +0.7/-0.3/-0.2/-0.8/+1.2/+2.6/+1.5, best 24 · 5.7/4.0/1.1 per game								
	32	J. Shepard	+0.2	23.4	9.5 5–20	7.3 5–11	3.6 2–6	0.0
80% of min, 32 GP · #66/212 league · 90%: pts 5-23 reb 4-13 ast 1-8 · 32.0 mpg, cap 40 · ptcile 73/60/73/99/37 · 19-25: +0.4/-0.4/+0.0/-1.7/-0.5, best 19 · 14.2/11.2/5.2 per game								
	7	A. Clark	-1.9	22.6	4.5 2–15	3.5 1–8	1.3 0–4	0.7
26% of min, 21 GP · #198/212 league · 90%: pts 2-18 reb 1-9 ast 0-5 · 10.4 mpg, cap 28 · ptcile 1/27/41/44/96 · 17-25: +1.1/+0.9/+1.6/+2.4/+0.9/+0.9/-0.7/-1.4, best 20 · 2.2/1.3/0.5 per game								
	1	O. Sims	-0.6	18.5	6.8 1–17	1.8 1–6	2.4 1–5	0.7
39% of min, 25 GP · #180/212 league · 90%: pts 0-21 reb 1-7 ast 0-6 · 15.6 mpg, cap 34 · ptcile 34/31/90/10/47 · 18-25: +1.1/+0.4/+0.2/-1.1/-0.5/-0.4/+1.1/+0.6, best 17 · 5.6/1.0/2.2 per game								
	34	A. Kuier	+0.1	18.4	6.9 4–18	4.1 2–8	1.0 1–4	0.8
40% of min, 31 GP · #89/212 league · 90%: pts 4-21 reb 2-9 ast 1-5 · 15.9 mpg, cap 31 · 21-23: +0.2/+0.9/-2.5, best 22 · 5.5/3.1/0.9 per game								
	20	M. Siegrist	+0.5	12.7	5.3 0–16	2.5 0–7	0.9 0–4	0.6
34% of min, 31 GP · #63/212 league · 90%: pts 0-19 reb 0-8 ast 0-5 · 13.7 mpg, cap 29 · ptcile 75/48/34/49/60 · 23-25: +1.4/+0.2/+1.5, best 25 · 5.9/2.7/0.9 per game								
	28	L. Yueru	+0.3	11.2	3.7 0–14	2.7 0–7	0.3 0–3	0.3
25% of min, 25 GP · #82/212 league · 90%: pts 0-18 reb 0-8 ast 0-4 · 10.1 mpg, cap 30 · ptcile 44/58/20/88/28 · 22-25: -0.4/-0.6/-0.4, best 25 · 3.2/2.8/0.4 per game								
		Team		200.0	84.5	36.0	19.6	7.5
ptcile = Offense / Defense / Playmaking / Rebounding / X-factor (2025 league percentile) · 90% = the range nine games in ten · players are projected from their last ten games unless the row says otherwise								

These two teams			IND	DAL
ROTATION IMPACT (minutes-weighted)			+0.86 (11 of 11 rated)	-0.00 (9 of 9 rated)

PROJECTED SCORE	85	84
SEASON RECORD	24-12	20-16
RECENT FORM (last 10)	8-2 · +8.8 avg margin	3-7 · -3.1 avg margin

Split 1-1 this season. 05-09 at IND: IND 104–DAL 107 · 08-14 at IND: IND 98–DAL 87. In 2025 they met 4 times, IND winning 3.

Who moved the win probability on 05-09 — DAL 107–IND 104.

This is an exact account of THAT GAME, not a rating of these players. It adds up every swing in win probability that happened while each player was on the floor. Because it describes a game that was already played rather than predicting one, it is exact — but it is also close to useless as a forecast: a player's number here tells us almost nothing about her next game, and it is not a ranking of who is good. Read it as a record of how this one night unfolded.

IND · T. Harris +6.7 (4 min, only 2 stints on court) · M. Hines-Allen -5.6 (19 min, 15 stints) · D. Dantas -13.8 (12 min, 14 stints) · R. Johnson -17.0 (10 min, 13 stints) · L. Hull -17.3 (13 min, 17 stints) · C. Clark -32.7 (28 min, 29 stints) · A. Boston -37.1 (23 min, 24 stints) · M. Timpson -38.8 (17 min, 21 stints) · S. Cunningham -40.1 (23 min, 23 stints) · K. Mitchell -58.8 (30 min, 32 stints) · **total -254.5**

DAL · P. Bueckers +69.8 (29 min, 29 stints) · J. Shepard +59.8 (29 min, 28 stints) · A. Ogunbowale +54.0 (26 min, 23 stints) · A. James +50.7 (14 min, 17 stints) · A. Smith +17.4 (18 min, 17 stints) · M. Siegrist +15.5 (16 min, 17 stints) · A. Kuier +11.0 (2 min, only 2 stints on court) · A. Clark +7.9 (4 min, 5 stints) · A. Fudd -4.2 (15 min, 19 stints) · L. Yueru -9.8 (3 min, 7 stints) · O. Sims -17.7 (22 min, 26 stints) · **total +254.4**

Win probability is in points, so +10.0 means a player was on the floor for swings worth ten points of it. Each total is simply the numbers beside it added up. They run large because five players share the floor for every move and each is charged with all of it, so a side adds to five times its own swing in the game; that holds to the last decimal before rounding, and the two sides can differ by a tenth once each player is rounded. DAL won that night.

Sources: rotation impact = each player's on-court impact rating weighted by the minutes we project her to play tonight; records, form and past meetings = completed game results only, never tonight's. Who moved the win probability = every on-court stint of that one completed meeting added up per player — a description of that game, never a forecast and never a season number.

THE SEASON SO FAR (through 426 games): Our spread calls miss by an average of 10.7 points · when we make a team a 60%+ favorite, they win 72% of the time · player minutes within +/-5.0, points within +/-4.1 (player lines: reconstructed day-before for all 143 games; live tracking began Jul 8.)
Recent monthly accuracy (average miss, lower is better): May '25 9.9 · Jun '25 10.7 · Jul '25 11.7 · Aug '25 10.0 · Sep '25 10.3 · May '26 11.1 · Jun '26 10.6 · Jul '26 12.2 points.
all-games: spread +/-10.7 · minutes +/-5.1 · points +/-4.1

Legend: big # = jersey · bold above the line = projected starters · IMPACT = points added vs an average player per 100 possessions (— = not yet rated, † = rated off her earlier record) · the grey figure under a number is the range it lands in four times in five · the grey strip under a player is her context: rank, floor-time share, wider ranges, minutes, percentiles, foul risk, what the numbers rest on, season averages · shaded either side of pick'em = each team's win chance, dark tick = our call · games missed = team games since she last appeared. How the numbers are made: this game's companion notes.

Generated 2026-08-20T04:24:21Z · dense analysis format — report of record · midnight projected drop. Built by The Hardwood from existing production models — no new models and no hand-entered numbers. Full methodology and sources are in this game's companion notes.